# Silsila — Requirements Elicitation Questionnaire

Prepared for the formal interview with the fiqh domain expert (nikah & talaq scope)

Purpose: this questionnaire is intended for a structured interview with the course's fiqh professor, to validate and refine the requirements for Silsila — a platform linking ayah, tafsir, hadith al-ahkam, mas'ala, khilaf between the madhahib, and qanun, scoped to nikah and talaq. An earlier, informal discussion with a PhD student in shariah shaped the initial draft requirements; this interview is meant to confirm, correct, and extend them with an authoritative source.

## A. Domain structure and organization

1. How do you typically organize nikah and talaq fiqh issues when teaching — by book/chapter, by ruling type, or another structure?
2. Which sub-topics within nikah and talaq would you consider essential to include in a first version (for example: conditions of a valid contract, mahr, types of talaq, iddah)?
3. Are there specific ayat al-ahkam you would consider the core verses students must know for nikah and talaq?

## B. Tafsir and hadith selection

1. When multiple tafsir works interpret the same ayah differently, which tafsir should be treated as "the adopted" one for teaching purposes, and why?
2. For a given mas'ala, how do you decide which hadith should be presented as the ruling hadith when more than one exists?
3. How important is it to display a hadith's authenticity grading (sahih, hasan, da'if) alongside it?

## C. Comparing madhab opinions (khilaf)

1. When presenting the four madhahib's positions on an issue, what information is essential for each — the ruling itself, the evidence relied on, the underlying reasoning ('illah)?
2. How do you determine or present the strongest opinion (rajih) on a disputed issue — should the platform show one, or leave it open to the reader?
3. Are there cases within nikah or talaq where a view outside the four madhahib (a contemporary fatwa or a minority position) should also be shown?

## D. Statute (qanun) mapping

1. Which statutes should be considered when mapping a fiqh ruling on nikah or talaq to modern law (for example, the Marriage Act or the Kadhis' Courts Act)?
2. Where fiqh and current statute diverge, how should that be presented to students?

## E. Usability and structure for students

1. What information do students most often need when comparing scholarly opinions on a mas'ala?
2. Would a tabular comparison (issue, reason for dispute, opinions, strongest opinion) match how you'd want this taught, or would you structure it differently?
3. What common mistakes or misunderstandings do students have when studying nikah/talaq fiqh that this tool could help prevent?

## F. Content governance and accuracy

1. Who should be qualified to review and approve a new content link (for example, a linked hadith or a stated madhab position) before it is published?
2. What would you consider a serious enough error in a proposed entry to reject it outright?

## G. Scope and prioritization

1. Of the nikah/talaq mas'alas, which would you prioritize for inclusion in a minimum viable version, and which could reasonably wait?
2. Are there any nikah or talaq issues that are especially sensitive or require particular care in how they are presented to students?